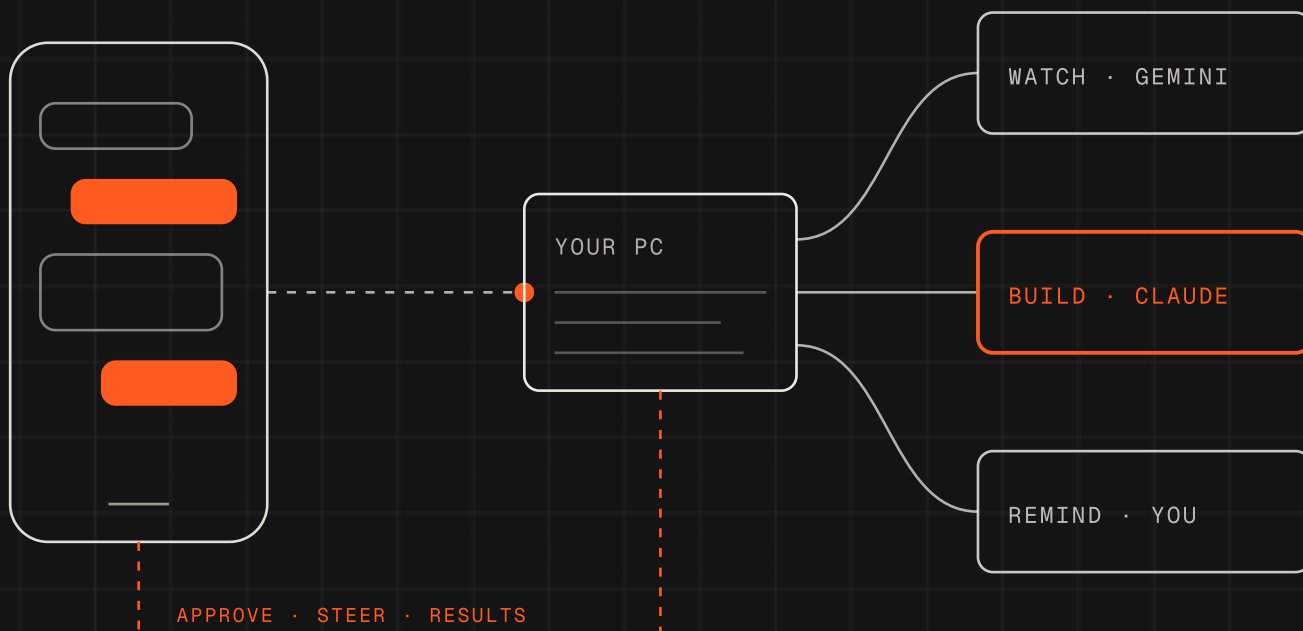




Reel Agent.

Set up your own Telegram bot that watches reels, explains them, and builds what they show on your PC, with your approval.

ABOUT 40 MINUTES
NO CODING NEEDED



CONTENTS

What's inside

Chapters 01–07 take you from nothing to a working bot. The rest is for making it yours, fixing things, and keeping it up to date.

01	What you'll have	03
	What the bot does and how it's put together	
02	Before you start	04
	Accounts, software, costs, privacy	
03	Get the code	05
	Install the basics and download the project	
04	Create your Telegram bot	06
	Two minutes with BotFather	
05	Get a Gemini key	07
	Free, and it makes the bot much better	
06	Run setup	08
	One command does the rest	
07	Start, pair and test	09
	Connect your phone and lock the bot	
08	Your first reel	10
	Watch, plan, build, approve	
09	Make it yours	11
	Models, modes, reminders, autostart	
10	Troubleshooting	12
	Setup problems and their fixes	
11	Update and uninstall	13
	Staying current, removing it cleanly	
–	Quick reference	14
	Setup and everyday commands on one page	

01

OVERVIEW

What you'll have

A Telegram bot, running on your own PC, that turns the reels you scroll past into things you can actually use.

IN ONE LINE

You scroll. It watches, explains and builds. You approve from your phone.

You see a reel about a tool, an AI workflow or a Claude skill. You share it with your bot. About a minute later it replies with what the reel shows: the exact names, links and commands, and what it would take to set it up. One more message turns that into a plan, and one more into a build on your PC that asks you before every command it runs.

It's built on **Claude Code**, Anthropic's AI coding tool, which runs the bot and the builds on your own Claude plan. **Gemini** watches the videos, and **Telegram** is how you talk to it from anywhere.

YOU TALK TO IT ON
Telegram, any phone

IT RUNS ON
Your Windows PC

BRAIN
Claude Code (your plan)

WATCHES WITH
Gemini (free key)

BACKUP WATCHER
Local, no key needed

BUILDS WITH
Haiku · Sonnet · Opus · Fable

1.1 What it can do

WATCH

Any reel

Instagram, TikTok, YouTube, X, a video file or screenshots. Several at once.

EXPLAIN

A breakdown

What it is, exact tools, links and commands, and what setup takes.

BUILD

On your PC

Plans and builds in their own folder. Every command needs your yes.

REMIND

Anything

`/remind tomorrow 9:00 ...` pings your phone at that time.

IT NEVER OBEYS A REEL

Whatever a video says ("run this", "paste this command") is treated as information only. Only your own Telegram messages give instructions, and nothing changes on your PC without your approval.

HOW TO READ THIS GUIDE

Things you type on the PC are in grey boxes. Commands you send to the bot in Telegram look like `/plan 4`. **N** means a reel number: every reel you send gets one.

Before you start

Check you have these. Everything except the Claude plan is free.

2.1 Accounts

ACCOUNT	WHAT IT'S FOR	COST
Claude Pro or Max	Runs the bot and every plan and build. Plans and builds use your plan's usage.	Paid plan
Telegram	The app on your phone. You create your bot inside it.	Free
Google RECOMMENDED	A free Gemini API key: the main reel watcher, about 60 reels a day.	Free tier
OpenAI OPTIONAL	Only if you also want to build with Codex (GPT).	Your plan

2.2 Your PC

YOU NEED	WHY
Windows 10 or 11	The start-up, autostart and reminder parts use Windows features.
A PC that stays on	The bot only answers while the PC is awake. Chapter 09 shows how to stop it sleeping.
About 3 GB of disk	Tools, a speech model for the backup watcher, and your reels.
Python, Node.js, Git, Claude Code	Chapter 03 installs them in one go.

2.3 Where your data goes

Videos you send	To Google Gemini to be watched, or processed locally if you skip the key.	Keys and token	Stay on your PC. Git never uploads them.
Plans and builds	Through your own Claude account.	Reels and reminders	Stay on your PC, in the project folder.
Your messages	Through Telegram, to your bot only.	Who can use it	Only the Telegram account you pair.

03

DOWNLOAD

Get the code

Install four basic tools, sign in to Claude Code once, and download the project.

01

Open PowerShell

Press **Start**, type **PowerShell**, and open **Windows PowerShell**. Every grey box in this guide is typed there.

02

Install the basics

Skip anything you already have. When it's done, **close PowerShell and open a new one** so it finds the new tools.

```
winget install Python.Python.3.13 OpenJS.NodeJS.LTS Git.Git
irm https://claude.ai/install.ps1 | iex          # Claude Code
```

03

Sign in to Claude Code

Run `claude`, follow the sign-in in your browser with your Claude account, then type `/exit`.

04

Download the project

Pick where it should live (it needs a folder of its own; builds go in a `builds` folder next to it), then:

```
cd $HOME
git clone https://github.com/HNF-FRN/Reel-watcher-telegram-Agent.git reel-agent
cd reel-agent
```

No Git? On the repository page choose **Code** → **Download ZIP**, unzip it, and open PowerShell in that folder.

3.1 What you downloaded

YOU'LL RARELY TOUCH

Only `.env` (your key) and, if you like, `CLAUDE.md` (how the bot behaves).

<code>reel-agent\</code>	
<code>setup.cmd · setup.py</code>	guided setup (chapter 06)
<code>bot.cmd · bot.ps1</code>	start / stop / status
<code>start.ps1</code>	the bot itself
<code>CLAUDE.md</code>	how the bot behaves
<code>MANUAL.md</code>	every command (/manual)
<code>.env.example</code>	becomes <code>.env</code> with your key
<code>.claude\</code>	skills, agent, permissions
<code>reminders\</code>	the reminder list
<code>docs\</code>	this guide

Create your Telegram bot

Telegram's own bot, BotFather, makes one for you in a short chat. You'll get a token: the key to your bot.

01 Open BotFather

In Telegram, search for **@BotFather** (blue check mark) and tap **Start**.

02 Send /newbot

It asks for a **name**: anything, like *My Reel Agent*.

03 Pick a username

It must be unique and end in `bot`, like `anna_reels_bot`. That becomes your bot's link.

04 Copy the token

BotFather replies with a long token like `123456789:AAHf...`. Copy all of it. Setup asks for it in chapter 06.

THE TOKEN IS A PASSWORD

Anyone who has it controls your bot. Don't post it, screenshot it or send it to anyone. If it leaks, send `/revoke` to BotFather for a new one.

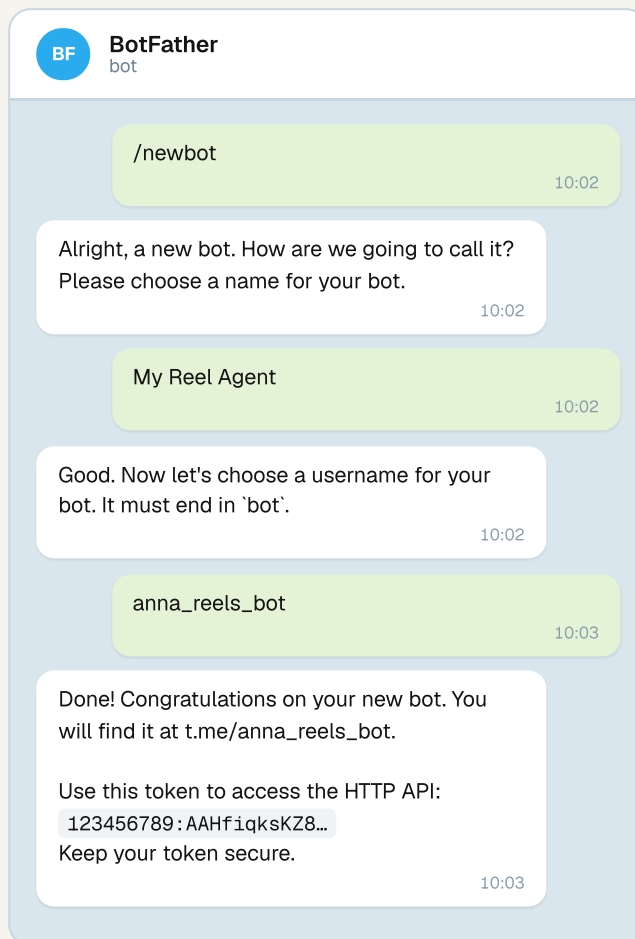


Figure 1. The whole conversation. Your wording may differ slightly.

Get a Gemini key

Optional, free, and worth it. Gemini watches the whole video with sound, which gives far better breakdowns than the backup watcher.

01

Open Google AI Studio

Go to aistudio.google.com/apikey and sign in with your Google account.

02

Create a key

Choose **Create API key**. If it asks for a project, let it create one. Copy the key (it starts with `AIza`). Setup asks for it in chapter 06.

5.1 What the free tier allows

About **20 videos a day and 5 a minute per model**, across three models: roughly 60 reels a day. It resets at midnight Pacific time. When it runs out, the bot quietly switches to the backup watcher and tells you so.

`/quota` shows how much is left.

5.2 Without a key

Everything still works. The backup watcher takes still frames and transcribes the audio on your PC. The first time, it downloads a speech model of about 500 MB. Breakdowns are a little less thorough.

PRIVACY

With a key, the videos you send are uploaded to Google to be watched. Google may use free-tier data to improve its products. If that matters to you, skip the key or enable billing on it.

06

SETUP

Run setup

One command checks everything, installs what's missing and saves your token and key. It asks before every change, and you can run it again any time.

```
cd $HOME\reel-agent
.\setup
```

Want to see what it would do first? `.\setup --check` only reports, and changes nothing.

6.1 What it does, step by step

STEP	WHAT HAPPENS	YOU ANSWER
1 • Tools	Checks Python, Git, Node.js and Claude Code. Installs Bun , which the Telegram connection runs on.	Y to install Bun
2 • Python packages	Installs the video downloader, the backup speech-to-text and ffmpeg.	Y
3 • Telegram	Installs the Telegram plugin for Claude Code, saves your bot token, and switches the plugin off for every other Claude session so only the bot uses it.	Y, paste the token (hidden), Y
4 • Gemini	Creates <code>.env</code> and saves your key in it. Git never uploads this file.	Paste the key, or Enter to skip
5 • Reminders	Sets up reminders in Windows Task Scheduler (nothing runs until one is due), and tells your other Claude sessions about the list.	Y, Y (both optional)
6 • Autostart	Starts the bot when you log in, adds a Sunday digest, and registers the command menu you see when you type <code>/</code> in the chat.	Y (optional)

6.2 When it finishes

```
6. Start with Windows, digest, menu
[ok] starts at login + Sunday digest task
[ok] Telegram '/' menu registered
-----
Setup complete. Next:
1. .\bot start
2. Message your bot on Telegram
3. /telegram:access pair <code>
```

Any **[todo]** lines are listed at the end with the exact fix. Fix them and run `.\setup` again: finished steps are skipped.

6.3 Why the plugin goes off

Telegram delivers each message to **one** connection only. If every Claude window on your PC loaded the Telegram plugin, whichever started last would quietly take your messages, and the bot would seem dead.

So setup switches it off globally, and the bot switches it back on for itself when it starts. Leave it that way.

Start, pair and test

Start the bot, tell it your Telegram account is the only one it answers, and check it responds.

01 Start the bot

```
.\bot start
```

A window opens with Claude Code in it. **That window is the bot:** keep it open (minimising is fine). If Claude asks whether you trust the folder, say yes.

02 Message your bot

Open your bot in Telegram (the link BotFather gave you) and send **hi**. It replies with a 6-character pairing code.

03 Pair, then lock

Type these **in the bot window** on the PC:

```
> /telegram:access pair a4f91c
> /telegram:access policy allowlist
```

The second line makes strangers get no reply at all.

04 Test it

From your phone send **/menu**, then **/pc**. Each should answer within a few seconds.

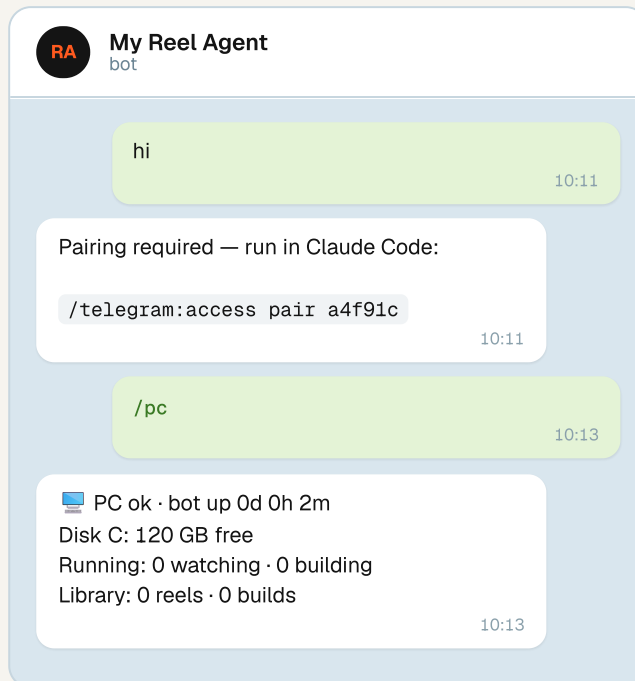


Figure 2. Pairing, then a health check. After pairing, only your account gets answers.

SILENT?

Run `.\bot status` on the PC. If it shows a problem, `.\bot fix`. More in chapter 10.

Your first reel

Share a reel, read the breakdown, and try a small build to see the approval flow.

01

Share a reel

In Instagram tap **Share** → **Copy link**, paste it to your bot and send. It answers *#1 watching it...*, and about a minute later sends the breakdown.

02

Plan it

`/plan 1` researches and sends a written plan. Nothing changes on your PC.

03

Build it

`/build 1` builds in its own folder next to the project. Before any command, your phone gets the exact command: answer `/yes 1` or `/no 1`.

04

Keep or throw away

`/diff 1` shows what changed, `/undo 1` removes it, and `/deploy 1` installs it where it belongs, after you confirm.

Don't have a reel handy?

`/new a script that prints today's date` creates an idea you can plan and build the same way.

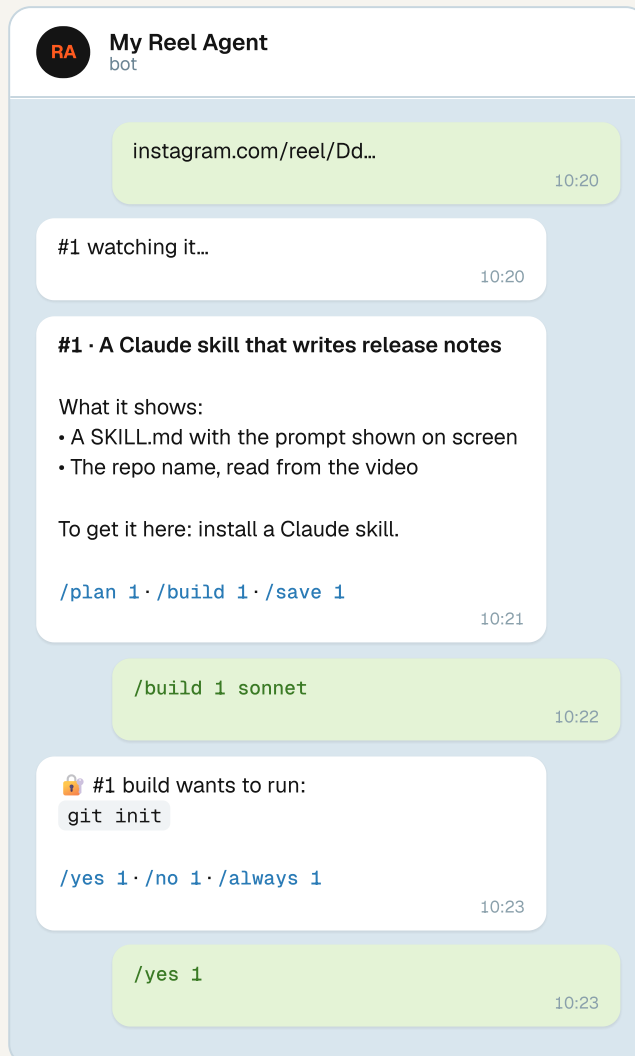


Figure 3. Watch, then build. Every command waits for your answer.

EVERY COMMAND

Type `/` in the chat for the full menu, or send `/manual 1` to get the complete manual on your phone.

Make it yours

Sensible defaults out of the box. Change them from your phone whenever you like.

9.1 Models

<code>/models</code>	Shows who does what
<code>/model build opus</code>	Tasks: <i>watch, research, plan, build</i>
<code>/build 4 haiku</code>	Override for one build

Defaults: watch Sonnet, research Haiku, plan Opus, build Sonnet. Opus and Fable use your Claude plan fastest; `/quota` shows how much is left.

9.2 How careful builds are

normal (default) edits files in its own folder freely and asks before every command. **safe** also asks before every edit: `/mode safe`. There's no mode that runs commands without asking.

9.3 Reminders

`/remind friday 18:00 renew the domain, /todo buy milk, /reminders`. If setup added the section to your global `CLAUDE.md`, you can also say "remind me..." in any Claude session on the PC.

9.4 Keep the PC awake

A sleeping PC means a silent bot. **Settings → System → Power → Screen and sleep** → "When plugged in, put my device to sleep after" → **Never**. The screen can still turn off.

9.5 Start with Windows

If you said yes in setup, the bot starts when you log in and restarts itself if it crashes. Change it any time with `.\bot autostart on` or `off`.

9.6 Change how it behaves

The bot's instructions are plain English in `CLAUDE.md`. Edit them (for example the breakdown format, or the default time units), then `.\bot restart`.

9.7 Build with Codex too

```
npm install -g @openai/codex
codex # sign in once
```

Then `/build 4 codex`. Codex builds are sandboxed to their folder instead of asking you.

10

FIXES

Troubleshooting

Start with `.\bot status` in the project folder. It checks the three things that matter most.

SYMPTOM	CAUSE	FIX
"python" / "claude" is not recognized	The terminal was open before the install.	Close PowerShell, open a new one, try again.
winget is not recognized	Older Windows without App Installer.	Install App Installer from the Microsoft Store, or install Python, Node.js and Git from their websites.
"running scripts is disabled"	Windows blocks PowerShell scripts by default.	Use <code>.\bot</code> and <code>.\setup</code> , which work regardless. For your own scripts: <code>Set-ExecutionPolicy -Scope CurrentUser RemoteSigned</code> .
Plugin install fails in setup	Plugin catalog not loaded yet.	Run <code>claude</code> , type <code>/plugin install telegram@claude-plugins-official</code> , then <code>.\setup</code> again.
No pairing code arrives	Bot not running, or the token is wrong.	<code>.\bot status</code> . If running, re-check the token: <code>.\setup</code> asks again if it's missing.
Worked once, then silent	Another Claude session loaded the Telegram plugin and takes the messages.	<code>.\bot fix</code> . Keep the plugin off globally (chapter 06).
It answers, then stops mid-task	The bot window is waiting for an answer.	Look for a  Permission message with buttons on your phone, or answer in the bot window.
"I couldn't grab that one"	The platform blocked the free download.	Save the video on your phone and send the file itself. <code>.\bot update</code> often helps too.
"Used the backup watcher"	Gemini's free quota is used up for today.	Wait for midnight Pacific, or enable billing on the key.
First reel very slow	No Gemini key: the speech model downloads once.	Let it finish (about 500 MB). Later reels are faster.
Reminder didn't arrive	PC asleep or off at that time.	It's sent when the PC wakes. Keep the PC awake (chapter 09).

11

UPKEEP

Update and uninstall

Updating takes a minute. Removing it cleanly takes five steps.

11.1 Update

```
# in the project folder
git pull          # new bot version
.\bot update      # tools
.\bot restart
```

Your key, token, reels and reminders are never touched by an update. Run `.\setup --check` afterwards if the release notes mention new steps.

11.2 At the PC

<code>.\bot status</code>	Running? Connected? Building?
<code>.\bot start · stop</code>	Open or close the bot
<code>.\bot restart</code>	After changing anything
<code>.\bot fix</code>	Remove extra connections

11.3 Uninstall

01 Stop it

```
.\bot stop
.\bot autostart off
```

02 Remove reminders

```
python reminders\remind.py uninstall
```

Also delete the "Reminders and to-dos" section from `~\.claude\CLAUDE.md` if setup added it.

03 Remove the plugin

```
claude plugin uninstall
telegram@claude-plugins-official
```

04 Delete the bot

Send `/deletebot` to BotFather, and delete the Gemini key in AI Studio.

05 Delete the folders

The project folder, and `builds` next to it if you want your builds gone too.

Quick reference.

Setup once, then everything happens from your phone. N is a reel number.

SETUP, ONCE

<code>git clone <url></code>	Download the project
<code>.\setup</code>	Checks and installs everything
<code>.\bot start</code>	Opens the bot window
<code>pair <code></code>	In the bot window: /telegram:access pair
<code>policy allowlist</code>	Then only you can use it

REELS

<code>a link / video</code>	Breakdown in about a minute
<code>/find words</code>	Search your reels
<code>/r N</code>	Resend a breakdown
<code>/save N</code>	Keep it for later
<code>/new idea</code>	Build without a reel

REMIND

<code>/remind when what</code>	Pings your phone then
<code>/todo what</code>	A to-do, no ping
<code>/reminders</code>	What's open
<code>/done R3</code>	Mark it done
<code>/snooze R3 1h</code>	Push it back

IF SOMETHING'S WRONG

<code>bot silent</code>	<code>.\bot status</code> , then <code>.\bot fix</code>
<code>no pairing code</code>	Is the bot running? Right token?
<code>download failed</code>	Send the video file itself
<code>scripts disabled</code>	Use <code>.\bot</code> and <code>.\setup</code>

AT THE PC

<code>.\bot status</code>	Running? Connected? Building?
<code>.\bot start · stop</code>	Open or close the bot
<code>.\bot restart</code>	After changing anything
<code>.\bot fix</code>	Bot went silent
<code>.\bot update</code>	Downloader + Claude Code

BUILD

<code>/plan N [model]</code>	A plan, changes nothing
<code>/build N [model]</code>	Build it on the PC
<code>/yes N · /no N</code>	Answer its request
<code>/tell N msg</code>	Steer or answer it
<code>/undo N</code>	Throw a build away

STATUS AND SETTINGS

<code>/menu · /manual</code>	All commands
<code>/pending</code>	Everything waiting on you
<code>/quota</code>	Gemini + Claude left
<code>/model build opus</code>	Change a default model
<code>/mode safe</code>	Ask before every edit

WHERE THINGS ARE

<code>.env</code>	Your Gemini key (never committed)
<code>CLAUDE.md</code>	How the bot behaves
<code>MANUAL.md</code>	Every command
<code>..\builds\</code>	What the bot built